

ALMILA BASAK

CONTACT INFORMATION	Department of Political Science Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs Syracuse University 024 Eggers Hall, Syracuse, New York 13244	@ abasak@syr.edu ☎ 315.560.8204
EDUCATION	Doctor of Philosophy — Political Science Syracuse University	2021 – 2027 (Expected)
	- Fields: Comparative Politics (Major), Law and Courts (Minor) - Dissertation: <i>Varieties of Right-Wing Populism Beyond Welfare Chauvinism</i> - Committee: Seth K Jolly (Chair), Margarita Estevez-Abe, Jessie Trudeau	
	Master of Arts — Political Science Syracuse University	2021 – 2023
	Bachelor of Science - Political Science and Public Administration Middle East Technical University, Turkey Minor: Economics	2014 – 2019
ACADEMIC AFFILIATIONS	Graduate Research Associate Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs, Center for European Studies, Syracuse University	2024 – Present
	Graduate Research Associate Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs, Middle Eastern Studies Program, Syracuse University	2023 – Present
	Teaching Associate Future Professoriate Program, Syracuse University	2023 – 2026

Research

RESEARCH INTERESTS	Subfields: Political Parties, Comparative Political Economy, Politics of Social Policy, Democratic Backsliding, European Politics, Turkish Politics	
RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS	Graduate Research Assistant , Dr. Jessie Trudeau .	Spring 2026
	Graduate Research Assistant , Dr. Jessie Trudeau .	Spring 2025
	Graduate Research Assistant , Dr. Jessie Trudeau .	2023-2024
	Global Free Speech Repository Research Assistant , Dr. Thomas Keck.	2022 – 2023
CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS	[4] "Dissatisfied Voters or Alienated Abstainers? Abstention and Voter-Parliament Incongruence"	May 2025

presented at the European Union Studies Association Conference with Prof Seth Jolly.

- [3] “Welfare State Policies: Window for Party Politics?,” September 2024
presented at the American Political Science Association Conference.
- [2] “Understanding the Unnatural Voting: The Case of AKP,” November 2022
presented at the Northeastern Political Science Association.
- [1] “Understanding the Unnatural Voting: The Case of AKP,” September 2022
presented at the Political Science Research Workshop at Syracuse University.

SKILLS

Statistics Software: R, R Studio, ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, GitHub, MAXQDA
Document Preparation Systems: L^AT_EX, R Markdown, Microsoft Office Suite

WORKING
PAPERS

- [3] "Welfare Promises of Populist Right Parties: Whom to Attract and How to Allocate?"
- [2] "The Electoral Returns to Bending Campaign Rules: Evidence from Brazil" (with Dr. Trudeau)
- [1] "Dissatisfied Voters or Alienated Abstainers? Abstention and Voter-Parliament Incongruence" (with Dr. Jolly)

Teaching

TEACHING
ASSISTANT

PSC 123 Comparative Government and Politics,
Prof Margarita Estevez-Abe Fall 2025
 Role: Section Leader

PSC 123 Comparative Government and Politics,
Prof Margarita Estevez-Abe Fall 2024
 Role: Section Leader

INSTRUCTOR OF
RECORD

PSC 388 Globalization and the Rise of Populism May 2024

Grants, Awards, and Honors

GRANTS

Summer Dissertation Fellowship
Syracuse University Graduate School April 2026

Research Assistantship Fellowship
Syracuse University Political Science Department Spring 2026

Roscoe Martin Fund for Dissertation and Thesis Research
Syracuse University Maxwell School 2025

Goekjian/Center for European Studies Research Grant
Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs 2025

Research Assistantship Fellowship
Syracuse University Political Science Department Spring 2025

	Professional, Academic and Creative Work Travel Grant <i>Syracuse University Graduate Student Organization</i>	2024
	Professional, Academic and Creative Work Travel Grant <i>Syracuse University Graduate Student Organization</i>	2023
	Fulbright PhD Scholarship	2022-23
	Fulbright PhD Scholarship	2021-22
AWARDS	Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award <i>Syracuse University Graduate School</i>	2026
	Koff Award <i>The best graduate student paper written each year on comparative politics</i> <i>Syracuse University Political Science Department</i>	2025
	Young Scholar Prize <i>For the paper” Social Policy and the Gender Gap in Party Preferences: The Case of the AKP era in Turkey”</i> <i>Syracuse University Middle East Studies Program</i>	2023
HONORS	Graduated as first-ranked student of the Middle East Technical University’s Political Science Department	June 2019
	Graduated as third-ranked student of the Middle East Technical University	June 2019

Service

TO THE INSTITUTION	Co-President , Political Science Graduate Student Association.	2023-2024
	Pre-Comprehensive Exams Student Representative , Political Science Graduate Student Association.	2022-2023
	Political Science Department Representative , Syracuse University Graduate Student Organization, Graduate Pandemic Committee member	2021-2022
TO THE DISCIPLINE	Panelist , <i>Independent Teaching as a Graduate Student</i> organized by Future Professoriate Program	October 2025
	Organizer , <i>Geocoding Workshop with Dr Trudeau</i> for Political Science Graduate Students.	October 2024
	Co-organizer , <i>Future Professoriate Program seminar: "Predocs, Postdocs, and Fellowships: What You Need to Know"</i> at Political Science Research Workshop, Syracuse University.	December 2023
PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS	European Political Science Society	2026 – Present
	Midwest Political Science Association	2026 – Present

European Union Studies Association
American Political Science Association

2025 – Present
2024 – Present

Updated April 10, 2026